

August 2026

Dear Christopher,

I've worked in Lamorinda long enough to know that a 1951 home with redwood-lined grounds, views of Orinda Country Club, and a kitchen with heated floors and dark quartz counters doesn't come along every season. When I saw 285 Camino Pablo come to market earlier this year, it stood out immediately. So when the listing came off the market at 140 days without a sale, I genuinely wanted to understand why.

The honest answer, as best as I can read the listing history, is that the strategy didn't match the home. At \$610 per square foot, this property was priced well below Orinda's renovated benchmark, which runs from \$790 to \$850 per square foot for updated homes. That's not a pricing problem, it's actually an asset. But a listing that describes the kitchen in a single clause and buries the golf course views and the redwood setting in the middle of a long feature list never built the case for what made this home worth driving out to see. The features were there. The story that connects them to a buyer wasn't.

I've put together a short analysis that walks through three specific places where the positioning fell short and what a relaunch strategy would look like for a home with this particular combination of assets. It's not a pitch, it's a review, and I think it'll be worth a few minutes of your time.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside with my best wishes. If you're not, I'd be glad to walk you through what I've put together and hear where things stand from your side.

With respect,



Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

285 Camino Pablo

Orinda, CA 94563

3.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,048 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 285 Camino Pablo

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Character-Rich 1951 Orinda Home with Views, Redwood Setting, and Modern Updates - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

285 Camino Pablo has the combination of assets that Orinda buyers in this price range are actively searching for: a thoughtfully updated interior with a gourmet kitchen, heated floors, steam shower, and smart home systems throughout, set on a 15,810-square-foot lot surrounded by mature redwoods with views of Orinda Country Club and the golf course. The lot depth, the outdoor entertaining areas with speakers and a projector capability, the greenhouse, and the finished garage with epoxy floors all speak to an owner who invested in the property with real attention. This is not a generic inventory home.

What the listing history tells us is that the strategy didn't keep up with what the home was offering. At \$610 per square foot against an Orinda renovated benchmark of \$790 to \$850, the home had meaningful room to attract buyers before they ever reached the price. Instead, the listing ran 140 days without a sale and came off the market unchanged. The marketing treated the redwood setting and the golf course views as secondary details rather than the opening argument for why this home is different from everything else at this price point. Buyers who might have been drawn in by the lifestyle were never given that story.

\$1,249,000

List Price

\$610/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one thing clearly: show buyers what \$610 per square foot on a redwood-framed lot with OCC views actually buys them, and make that case through visuals and narrative before a single showing is scheduled.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 140 Days Without a Pivot

After 140 days on the market, buyer psychology around 285 Camino Pablo had shifted in a direction that had nothing to do with the home itself. Past the 45-day mark, buyers stop asking whether a home is right for them and start asking what everyone else saw that they didn't. That stigma accumulates daily and it isn't earned by the property, it's created by a strategy that kept running without adjusting. The listing never relaunched with a fresh media build, a repositioned narrative, or a different distribution approach. It simply continued on the same path until it came off the market. The right buyer for a redwood-set, golf-view home in Orinda was out there during those 140 days. The listing just didn't reach them.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses its private off-market buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com to reset a home's exposure with a clean slate, reaching Bay Area buyers who have opted in to receive property alerts before anything re-enters the public MLS.

Friction #2: The Visual Story Was Never Told

The combination of redwood-lined grounds, poetic vistas of the OCC golf course, blue tile pathways, and a lot that steps up to elevated outdoor living areas is not something a buyer can picture from a standard front-elevation photo and a few interior shots. These are the features that justify the drive from San Francisco or Oakland for a first showing, and they live or die on how they're presented before that decision is made. The listing description mentioned the views and the setting, but without aerial context showing the lot's position, its relationship to the golf course, and the depth of the redwood canopy, buyers experienced those words as marketing language rather than something real. At \$1,249,000 in a market where competing Orinda homes are photographed to their full potential, that gap in visual storytelling was costly.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour gives buyers the aerial neighborhood context to understand exactly where a home sits relative to its setting, something no ground photograph or satellite image can replicate for a lot like this one.

Friction #3: A Price Well Below Benchmark With No Story Behind It

At \$610 per square foot, 285 Camino Pablo was priced meaningfully below Orinda's renovated-home range of \$790 to \$850 per square foot. That should have been a competitive advantage that drew buyers in quickly. Instead, the listing ran 140 days without generating a sale, which suggests the marketing never framed the value clearly enough for buyers to act on it. When a well-priced home sits, it usually means buyers weren't given a compelling reason to prefer it over other options at similar price points in adjacent cities. The listing described features in sequence without building a case for what made this specific home a standout at this number. Buyers comparing Orinda against Lafayette or Moraga needed to feel the answer before they called to schedule.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda from San Francisco and the East Bay, putting the home's specific value story in front of decision-makers before they've settled on a neighborhood.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	285 Camino Pablo	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$610/sqft	Orinda renovated: \$790–\$850/sqft
Lot / Setting	15,810 sq ft, mature redwood canopy, multi-area outdoor entertaining	Typical Orinda lot: 8,000–12,000 sq ft, standard landscaping
Architectural Character	1951 original with vaulted ceilings, beams, hardwood floors, artistic renovation	Standard updated inventory, neutral finishes
Premium Features	Heated kitchen and primary suite floors, steam shower, smart home systems, greenhouse, golf course views	Standard appliance upgrades, no specialty systems
HOA	None	Varies; \$0–\$300/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$610/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$790-\$850/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$610 per square foot, this home came to market at the low end of Orinda's renovated-home range, which means the value was genuinely there for buyers who understood it. The listing's challenge was not price. It was that the marketing never made the case for why this particular combination of lot, setting, views, and finishes justifies a buyer choosing Orinda at this number over comparable options elsewhere. A relaunch built around that story, supported by the right aerial and immersive visuals, starts from a fundamentally stronger position than the first listing did.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Show the Lot Before You Show the Rooms

The redwood canopy, the stepped outdoor areas, the blue tile pathways, and the golf course views are the features that make 285 Camino Pablo different from everything else in its price range. But those assets are invisible in standard interior photography. A relaunch strategy leads with the setting, not the floor plan, and uses aerial coverage to establish the lot's context before a buyer ever looks at a kitchen photo. BrightWork's Sky Tour is built exactly for properties where the exterior story is the premium argument.

Pillar II - Reach the Right Buyer Before They Find Something Else

The buyer for this home is likely a professional household relocating from San Francisco or the inner East Bay, shopping Orinda because of the schools, the setting, and the lifestyle, but still doing their research online before committing to a drive. That buyer needs to encounter this property with a full picture of what the redwood setting and the OCC views look like in person, not after they've already scheduled showings for three other homes. A targeted digital campaign built around Lamorinda-researching SF and East Bay buyers puts this home in front of that decision point at the right time.

Pillar III - Build the Case for the Number Before the Listing Goes Live

At \$610 per square foot against a renovated Orinda benchmark of \$790 to \$850, this home's value story is strong on the numbers. The listing that ran for 140 days never fully made that argument in a way buyers could act on. A relaunch pairs a narrative that connects the specific finishes, the heated floors, the steam shower, and the smart home systems directly to the price point, so buyers arrive at a showing already understanding what they're getting, not still trying to figure it out. That clarity shortens the path from first online view to written offer.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

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Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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